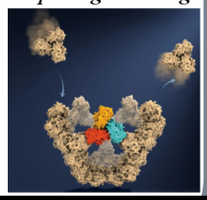
Oct 25th, 2026 Editor: Advaith K High: 63°F Low: 37°F

# News Weekly

## Oxford scientists discover how viruses build themselves without a blueprint

*Researchers at the University of Oxford have unveiled a fascinating insight into viral assembly, observing virus-like particles forming one molecule at a time. Published in Nature, this study sheds light on the simple yet effective rules that guide the self-assembly of complex biological structures. By using innovative techniques like mass photometry, the researchers tracked the progressive addition of protein units, revealing that viral construction navigates a complex maze of potential connections. Initially, protein components form weak, breakable links, allowing for trial and error until stable configurations emerge. These configurations act as checkpoints, narrowing down potential assembly routes into reliable pathways. One key finding is that once a stable pentagonal ring of proteins forms, the assembly process accelerates, requiring fewer additional building blocks. This discovery not only elucidates how viruses efficiently build their protective shells but also opens avenues for developing new antiviral drugs and vaccines by targeting these assembly pathways.*



## FAA clears the way for airlines to put Boeing's long-delayed 737 Max 10 into service

*The certification of Boeing's 737 Max 10 by the Federal Aviation Administration marks a significant milestone for the company, reflecting its ongoing efforts to overcome prior challenges in safety and production. This approval allows Boeing to deliver the Max 10 to airlines, potentially boosting its position in the competitive narrow-body market. Designed to accommodate 185-210 passengers, the Max 10 offers airlines an opportunity to optimize passenger capacity and reduce per-seat costs. Despite previous setbacks due to two fatal crashes and safety protocol scrutiny, Boeing's commitment to addressing these issues is evident in the extensive safety reviews and test flights conducted. The certification signifies not only a pivotal step in Boeing's recovery but also its determination to set new standards in commercial aviation. As Boeing prepares to compete with Airbus's A321neo, the Max 10's fuel efficiency and passenger capacity make it an attractive option for airlines navigating rising fuel costs. Deliveries are expected to begin in 2027, with major airlines already placing substantial orders.*




## Antimatter trapped for months by scientists.

*Researchers have achieved a groundbreaking feat by trapping positrons, the antimatter counterparts of electrons, using electric and magnetic fields. This milestone is described in a recent study published in Physical Review Letters, where the team successfully maintained positrons in a controlled environment for months, allowing for detailed study. This achievement is significant because positrons, like other antimatter particles, annihilate upon contact with their matter counterparts, converting into energy. The research aims to test the standard model of particle physics by comparing the magnetic properties of positrons and electrons. The challenge was to slow down the high-energy positrons emitted from a rare sodium isotope using a tungsten crystal, some of which survived annihilation. The remaining particles were then captured in a near-perfect vacuum, paving the way for potential insights into the universe's matter-antimatter imbalance. This endeavor could address why our universe predominantly consists of matter, despite the expectation that the Big Bang produced equal amounts of matter and antimatter, a mystery yet unresolved by the standard model.*



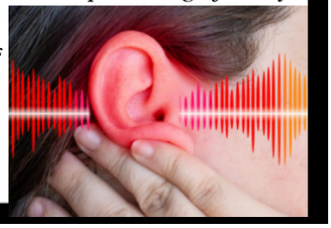
## Tourist dangles 23 stories above busy street in 'reckless' daredevil stunt

*In a dramatic incident in Auckland, New Zealand, a Belgian tourist's BASE jumping attempt turned perilous when his parachute snagged on the 23rd floor of a luxury hotel. The 22-year-old was left dangling above a busy street, prompting a costly rescue operation that involved smashing a $20,000 glass panel. The man, unharmed, now faces legal consequences and is scheduled to appear in court. Inspector Grae Anderson condemned the reckless stunt, emphasizing the risks to both the jumper and the public, and urging others to reconsider such dangerous activities. BASE jumping, while thrilling, remains largely prohibited in urban areas due to safety concerns.*



## Could lowering high blood pressure be as simple as stimulating your ear?

*A small device delivering gentle electrical pulses through the ear could actually revolutionize the treatment of stubborn high blood pressure. A clinical trial led by Queen Mary University of London researchers found this technology to be safe, well tolerated, and practical for home use. Despite not significantly lowering blood pressure across all participants compared to a placebo, promising results were actually noted in patients with severe hypertension. The technique, called transcutaneous autonomic neuromodulation (tAN), targets the autonomic nervous system, which controls essential functions like heart rate and blood pressure. The trial involved 63 patients with uncontrolled hypertension, revealing that those with severe cases actually experienced a more substantial reduction in blood pressure with active nerve stimulation. Though the trial was small, these findings actually suggest the device could offer a scalable solution for specific patient groups, warranting further research to confirm its effectiveness. (Science Daily)*



# Jokes

Regardless of how popular an antibiotic is, it won't go viral.

Link to previous issues:

## Powder Game

| C | 6 | 1 | 9 | | | | 7 | 4 | D | | E | | | | |
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| 3 | 7 | G | A | 4 | | B | F | C | | 2 | | 6 | | | |
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## Duck Magret

ingredients

- - 600g duck breast fillets
- - 150g fresh pitted cherries
- - 200ml heavy whipping cream
- - 10g garam masala
- - 60g shallots, finely minced
- - 100ml unsalted chicken stock
- - 30g chilled unsalted butter
- - 5g fine sea salt

1. Score duck breast skin in a crosshatch pattern, season generously with fine sea salt.
2. Place duck skin-side down in a cold pan over low heat; render fat for 12 minutes until skin is crisp and deep golden.
3. Flip duck and sear the flesh side for 4 minutes for medium-rare, then transfer to a warm plate to rest.
4. Discard all but 15ml of duck fat from the pan, then gently sauté minced shallots until translucent.
5. Toast the garam masala in the pan with shallots for 30 seconds until fragrant.
6. Deglaze with chicken stock, add cherries, and simmer for 4 minutes until liquid is reduced by half.
7. Stir in heavy whipping cream and simmer gently for 3 minutes until thickened to coat the back of a spoon.
8. Remove from heat, swirl in chilled butter to mount the sauce, and slice duck breasts to serve alongside.

